Our insight, in four lines

We moved from collecting more preferences to making selected needs easier to express, interpret and fulfil. The four lines below are our evidence-qualified synthesis.

The Assumption

We believed that collecting guests' expressed preferences before arrival would allow the hotel to prepare a room that felt like home from the moment they entered.

The Data

The evidence shows that assistants often mediate bookings in our selected context, while some needs emerge only during the stay. It also shows that trusted calls can already work well, some private needs are deliberately withheld, and MO already has preference records and service guidance.

The Insight

So we now believe that helping these guests feel recognised depends on connecting the needs they choose to share with trusted human judgement and a feasible service response. Optional visual prompts may help assistants express unfamiliar possibilities; Dream Makers may add contextual understanding, provided each action has consent, ownership and delivery limits.

The Invalidation

We would be wrong if existing trusted channels already conveyed the relevant needs adequately, if target assistants preferred those channels to our prototype, or if the added discovery and coordination failed to improve recognition within the hotel's capacity.

How our interpretation changed

Our workshop statement connected guest, agent and staff knowledge around the idea of "feeling at home". The final playback sharpened this into two gaps: needs left unsaid online and situational observations that were difficult to share.

On reviewing the full assistant transcript and GXP deck, we had to qualify that story. More disclosure is not always desirable, and a lack of disclosure is not automatically a failure of texting. We cannot claim that MO has no shared process. Our proposed contribution is a clearer connection between optional expression, situational learning and operational confirmation.

What the service has to connect

Knowledge	The question we carry forward
Assistant's knowledge	What can be shared for this stay, through a channel the guest and assistant trust?
Guest's choice	What is wanted, unwanted, uncertain or deliberately private?
Dream Maker's observation	What is a useful clue, and what still requires clarification?
Hotel's capacity	Who can deliver, by when, at what cost, and who confirms it?

Fig. 2. A reading of the service relationship, redrawn for this case study. These are questions for validation, not confirmed user behaviours.